

NEEL THOMAS

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Mesa, Arizona (permanent resident)



CAREER OBJECTIVE

DevOps / SRE with 10+ years of experience building scalable, reliable infrastructure and internal platforms across cloud-native environments. Strong background in Kubernetes, observability, and developer enablement, with recent focus on AI infrastructure, AIOps, and MCP platforms.

EXPERIENCE

- Life360** San Mateo, CA, US
Aug 2025 – Present
 - Part of the **Cloud Success team**, responsible for CI/CD, observability, and release pipeline management across Life360.
 - Built **Eagle-Eye**, an internal AI-powered observability tool (later evolved under AI-Core), providing a single-pane-of-glass view across metrics, logs, alerts, and debugging context for on-call engineers.
 - Open-sourced Eagle-Eye as an MCP server (GitHub), with **10+ public stars and growing**, validating real-world adoption and community interest.
 - Developed an **infrastructure capacity planning MCP** using Datadog time-series metrics and Facebook Prophet to forecast traffic spikes and proactively plan CPU, memory, and HPA scaling for peak events (e.g., ~20% Back-to-School traffic increase).
 - Led technical evaluation of **30+ AI developer tools and MCP frameworks** (e.g., Langfuse), establishing standards for observability, security, and operational readiness.
 - Created an internal vibe-coding platform called **SLICK (Streamlit One-Click)**, built on top of the existing GitOps stack to enable rapid deployment of AI-powered applications.
 - SLICK adopted by **10+ internal teams**, with the largest success in Ads and Marketing, enabling a chat application integrating **Databricks MCP** using **Claude function calling**.
 - Designed and provisioned a dedicated **EKS cluster for custom MCP workloads**, defining standardized deployment and operational patterns.
- Sr Software Engineer, Network Operations** June 2023 – July 2025
 - Part of the Infrastructure Observability team supporting **100M+ global users**.
 - Owned observability for **125+ Kubernetes-based backend services**, including metrics, logs, alerts, and incident response tooling.
 - Implemented Vector to replace third-party logging agents, enabling centralized log ingestion with sensitive data redaction.
 - Platform processes **6TB+ logs daily**, deployed on Kubernetes with **Karpenter-based autoscaling**.
 - Deployed Prometheus on EKS using kube-prometheus-stack and implemented PrometheusRule CRDs.
 - Led a successful **OpenTelemetry proof-of-concept** and authored an **Architecture Decision Record (ADR)** for a vendor-neutral instrumentation strategy to reduce Datadog lock-in and simplify developer onboarding; rollout deferred due to existing Datadog contractual constraints.
 - Deployed an **eBPF-based service mapping solution** for real-time dependency visualization across Kubernetes services.
- Dview.io** Bangalore, India
Nov 2022 – May 2023
 - DevOps Engineer

- Founding engineer at a pre-seed data platform startup.
- Designed and implemented full AWS infrastructure using Terraform, Terragrunt, and Atlantis.
- Built multi-region EKS clusters (us-east-1, ap-south-1).
- Implemented GitOps deployments using ArgoCD.
- Defined SLI/SLO frameworks and observability using Prometheus, Grafana, and SigNoz.

- **Freelance Consultant**

DevOps Consultant

India / UAE
May 2022 – Nov 2022

- Delivered end-to-end cloud and Kubernetes infrastructure for startups.
- Provided DevOps advisory to 5+ SaaS portfolio companies associated with Together Fund.

- **Zolve**

Site Reliability Engineer

Bangalore, India
Apr 2021 – May 2022

- Built the entire cloud and Kubernetes infrastructure for a neobank valued at \$210M.
- Managed 20+ microservices on AWS EKS across two regions.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines and GitOps workflows.
- Built observability using Prometheus, Grafana, and New Relic.

- **Careem**

Site Reliability Engineer

Dubai, UAE
Sept 2019 – Sept 2020

- Delivered AWS cost optimizations saving \$336K annually for Careem Pay.
- Maintained IaC using Terraform and CloudFormation.
- Migrated production services from Elastic Beanstalk to EKS.
- Participated in 24/7 on-call rotation.

- **Ola Cabs**

DevOps Engineer

Bangalore, India
Oct 2017 – Aug 2019

- Maintained large-scale CI/CD platforms using Jenkins and Mesos.
- Migrated payment workloads from AWS to Azure, saving ~20% infra costs.

- **Poornam Info Vision**

Linux System Engineer

Kochi, India
May 2015 – Sept 2017

- Provided Linux administration support for 25+ global clients.
- Handled security incidents including spam, spoofing, and intrusion mitigation.

EDUCATION

- **College of Engineering**

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science (80%)

Poonjar, India
2011 – 2015

SKILLS

- **Languages & IaC:** Golang, Bash, Terraform, Terragrunt, CloudFormation
- **Cloud:** AWS, Azure
- **Platforms & Tools:** Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Rollouts, KEDA, Kyverno, Istio, Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, New Relic, Vector, OpenTelemetry, Atlantis, Linux